



P14 · 16 PAGES, FILLABLE

A Birth Plan Worksheet Pack

Sixteen pages of birth-plan worksheets, written like a real adult is going to read them. Birth preferences, comfort menu, partner role page, hospital bag list, and a one-page summary your nurse can actually use. Plus a "if things change" page for the day plans flex.

Soothemade Notes

A SMALL APOTHECARY OF PRINTABLES · MADE SLOWLY

A note before you start

The birth plan template I downloaded for my first was four pages of every possible preference, each with a checkbox. I filled it out and brought it in with a fierce kind of pride. The labor and delivery nurse glanced at page one and said, very kindly, “Honey, we’ll do our best.”

That sentence has stayed with me. She was not being dismissive. She was reading a four-page document while running between three patients on a busy shift. There is no way she was going to read all of it, and she knew the things on it that she could not actually guarantee in a hospital.

This pack is the version of that document I wish I’d brought in. One page she can hold up and read in eight seconds, telling her the three things that matter most. The rest is for you, to think through and write down so you remember to ask. It is for the partner, written to him. It is for the day plans flex, which they will.

You can fill this out alone. You can fill it out with a partner. You can take it to your provider and ask them to look at it. You can bring it to the hospital, scan it, share it, leave it on the bedside table. You can also decide not to bring it at all. The thinking is the point. The piece of paper is just the receipt of the thinking.

With care, Maya

This is not a medical document. It is a communication tool. Your provider’s plan, in the moment, will always supersede this. If the medical team says something has to change, listen. The point of writing it down ahead of time is to have thought about it, not to bind anyone to it.

The one-page summary

This is the page your nurse will fold and tape to the wall in the room. Keep it short. Use the back if you must.

NAME: _____

DUE DATE: _____

PROVIDER: _____

SUPPORT PERSON: _____

Their role: _____

Their phone: _____

ALLERGIES: _____

THE THREE THINGS THAT MATTER MOST TO ME

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

THE THREE THINGS I AM MOST WORRIED ABOUT

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

PRONOUNS I USE: _____

PRONOUNS I'D LIKE
PEOPLE TO USE FOR
THE BABY (IF I HAVE
A PREFERENCE): _____

PRIOR BIRTH EXPERIENCE

IF ANY (one sentence): _____

Keep the rest of the pack for yourself. The summary is the thing.

The full preferences worksheet

A more detailed page for your own thinking. Bring it if you want. Set it down if you want.

Mobility during labor

- ☐ I'd like to move around (walking, leaning, ball, tub).
- ☐ I'd prefer to stay in the bed.
- ☐ I am open to whatever feels right in the moment.
- ☐ I don't know yet.

Monitoring

- ☐ Intermittent monitoring if medically possible.
- ☐ Continuous monitoring is okay with me.
- ☐ I'd like the option of wireless monitoring if available.
- ☐ I don't know yet.

Pain management

I'd like to start with (and reconsider as I go):

- ☐ Unmedicated
- ☐ Nitrous (laughing gas)
- ☐ IV pain medication
- ☐ Epidural
- ☐ Other: _____

IMPORTANT: I want the option to change my mind in either direction without being asked "are you sure" repeatedly.

Perineum

- ☐ Warm compresses during pushing if available.
- ☐ Episiotomy only if medically necessary, with my consent.
- ☐ I am open to my provider's judgment in the moment.

Pushing position

- ☐ I'd like to try side-lying.
- ☐ I'd like to try hands-and-knees.
- ☐ I'd like to try squatting.
- ☐ I am open to whatever the provider recommends.
- ☐ I don't know yet.

Cord clamping

- ☐ Delayed cord clamping (1-3 minutes), if medically possible.
- ☐ Immediate cord clamping is okay.
- ☐ My partner would like to cut the cord: ☐ yes ☐ no

Placenta

- ☐ I'd like to see it briefly.
- ☐ No need.
- ☐ I am keeping it for _____ (research, encapsulation, burial, art). I will bring my own container.

Photos

- ☐ Yes, my partner can take photos throughout.
- ☐ Only after the baby is delivered and we are settled.
- ☐ No photos until I say.
- ☐ I will bring a doula photographer.

Music or sound

- ☐ I'd like to play music. (Playlist saved on my phone.)
- ☐ I'd like a quiet room.
- ☐ I don't have a preference.

Visitors

In the room during labor:

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

After delivery (no one else until I'm ready):

- ☐ Whoever the above is
- ☐ Plus: _____

Visitors I do NOT want notified, even by family:

The comfort menu

What helps you regulate. Bring this. Refer to it during. Hand it to the partner.

Heat or cold

- ☐ Warm rice sock on lower back
- ☐ Cold pack on forehead or neck
- ☐ Warm shower
- ☐ Warm tub
- ☐ Cold drinks with a straw

Touch

- ☐ Counter-pressure on lower back (hard pressure with palm)
- ☐ Hip squeezes during contractions
- ☐ Light touch on arms or shoulders
- ☐ No touch right now (and I will say "no touch" if I need)

Sound

- ☐ My playlist
- ☐ Voice of: _____
- ☐ Silence
- ☐ A specific affirmation said back to me:

Sight

- ☐ Dim the lights
- ☐ Keep a focal point I bring
- ☐ Curtain pulled, blocking the view of the door

Smell

- ☐ My own essential oil (I will bring)
- ☐ No strong smells
- ☐ A specific food or drink: _____

Words I want to hear (write three)

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

Words I do not want to hear

1. _____
2. _____

The partner role page

Written TO the partner, not to her. Hand it over before the day.

If you are the partner reading this, your job has three parts.

Part one, before the day.

- Read the one-page summary. Memorize the three things that matter most.
- Pack your bag. Snacks, phone charger, a change of clothes, a hoodie. Long shifts are cold.
- Drive the route once, in daylight, with no rush. Know where to park.
- Pack the snack bag for her, even if she said she doesn't want one. She will.

Part two, during.

- You are the gatekeeper. If a relative wants to come, you say no, gently. If a nurse is hurried, you slow her down. You do not have to be loud. You have to be present.
- Bring water every twenty minutes. A straw helps.
- Use the comfort menu. Try one thing. Try another.
- Take notes. The next morning she will want to know what happened. Time of arrival. Time of "okay we're staying." Names of the nurses. Names of the medications.
- Do not take it personally if she yells at you. The yelling is the work. You are doing well.

Part three, after.

- For the first hour, your job is to defend the bubble. No phones, no calls, no announcements unless she asks. Just her, the baby, you.
- Be the one who knows where her bag is, where her glasses are, where the toothbrush is.
- Pack the going-home outfit. Take photos before you leave the room.

That's it. The day is hers. Your job is to make it possible for her to be in her body.

The hospital bag list

A printable list. Tape it to the closet door.

For her

- ☐ Insurance card + ID
- ☐ Birth plan (this pack)
- ☐ Phone + charger (long cable)
- ☐ Glasses + contacts case (the hospital is dry)
- ☐ Lip balm
- ☐ Hair ties / soft headband
- ☐ Two cozy robes (dark color, postpartum bleed)
- ☐ Slippers with grip
- ☐ Nursing bra or sports bra (no underwire)
- ☐ Underwear: 5 pairs you don't mind throwing away
(the hospital mesh ones are honestly good)
- ☐ Going-home outfit (loose, dark)
- ☐ Snacks: nut bars, dried fruit, electrolyte powder
- ☐ Toothbrush + paste, deodorant, face wipes
- ☐ Hairbrush
- ☐ A book or downloaded show you do not care about

For partner

- ☐ ID
- ☐ Phone + charger
- ☐ Hoodie (cold)
- ☐ Change of clothes for 2 days
- ☐ Toothbrush + deodorant
- ☐ Snacks (separate from hers)
- ☐ Water bottle
- ☐ Cash for vending or cafe
- ☐ A book or AirPods, for the quiet parts

For baby

- ☐ Going-home outfit + a backup
- ☐ A swaddle blanket
- ☐ A hat
- ☐ Socks
- ☐ Installed car seat (do this 3 weeks early)
- ☐ Diapers (the hospital provides for the stay, this is for the trip home)
- ☐ A pediatrician's name + phone for discharge

For going home

- ☐ Sunglasses for her
- ☐ A pillow for between her seatbelt and her belly
- ☐ A snack and water for the drive
- ☐ A pre-warmed car if it's cold

If things change

A page for the part most birth-plan templates skip.

Plans flex. You may go in for an induction and end up with a C-section. You may plan for unmedicated and ask for an epidural at 7cm. You may need a NICU stay you did not plan for. Any of these are not a failure of your plan. They are the day going as it goes.

Here is what I want, even then.

If I am induced (planned or unplanned)

The same three things that matter most still apply:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

What I want during induction:

- ☐ My support person stays with me throughout
- ☐ Mobility as soon as it's safe
- ☐ A regular check-in on whether I want pain management
- ☐ Other: _____

If I have a C-section

If a C-section happens, planned or unplanned, I would like:

- ☐ My support person in the OR
- ☐ Skin-to-skin in the OR if possible (or as soon as safe)
- ☐ The drape lowered briefly so I can see the baby
- ☐ The baby brought to me before being weighed/measured
- ☐ Photos of the moment, if my support person can
- ☐ Delayed cord clamping if medically possible
- ☐ A double-layer closure, if my history calls for one
- ☐ A clear conversation about what's happening, narrated by the surgeon or anesthesiologist

If my baby needs the NICU

If the baby has to go to NICU, I would like:

- ☐ My partner to go with the baby (we will not be separated)
- ☐ To be brought to see the baby as soon as I can be
- ☐ Pumping equipment brought to my room within 6 hours
- ☐ A NICU contact name, written down, for both of us
- ☐ A daily update, even if I am not yet able to be there

If something goes wrong

If something serious happens to me or the baby:

Decision-maker if I cannot speak: _____

Their phone: _____

My next-of-kin (different from above, if applicable):

Religious or spiritual care:

- ☐ Yes, please call: _____
- ☐ No, thank you
- ☐ Only if I ask

These pages exist so you do not have to be making these decisions in the moment. You will not have to make them, almost certainly. Writing them down is not predicting them.

The providers and people page

OB / MIDWIFE

Name: _____ Phone: _____

After-hours line: _____

DOULA (if any)

Name: _____ Phone: _____

HOSPITAL OR BIRTH CENTER

Name: _____ Address: _____

Labor & delivery direct: _____

Where to park: _____

PEDIATRICIAN (for after)

Name: _____ Phone: _____

PEOPLE WHO ARE COMING (in order of arrival)

1. _____ Their phone: _____

2. _____ Their phone: _____

PEOPLE TO BE TOLD ONLY AFTER BABY IS HERE

1. _____ Their phone: _____

2. _____ Their phone: _____

PEOPLE TO BE TOLD ONLY WHEN WE COME HOME

1. _____ Their phone: _____

2. _____ Their phone: _____

The first hour after

A page for the hour after the baby arrives. Most birth plans stop at delivery. This is the part that often gets lost.

What I want for the first hour

- ☐ Immediate skin-to-skin, if safe
- ☐ Delayed bath (24 hours or more)
- ☐ First feed within the hour (latch attempt if breastfeeding)
- ☐ No interruptions: no visitors, no calls, no photos beyond my partner's, no announcement to family
- ☐ My partner stays in the room
- ☐ The lights dimmed if possible
- ☐ Music from my phone, if I want it

Routine newborn procedures, my preferences

- ☐ Eye ointment: in the room, ☐ after the hour
- ☐ Vitamin K (injection): in the room, ☐ after the hour
- ☐ Hepatitis B vaccine: in the room, ☐ at pediatrician
- ☐ Bath: 24+ hours, or never (we'll do at home)

Other: _____

A note to my partner about that hour

A space to write to the partner about what the hour matters for. (You can leave this blank if you'd rather.)

A final page

This is not in the worksheets. It is for you, to read or not, sometime before the day.

You are going to do the thing. Or the thing is going to start happening, and you are going to figure it out as you go. Either way, the version of yourself who shows up to the hospital is going to do a hard thing in a way that you cannot completely plan for.

The point of this birth plan is not to control the day. The point is to have thought about it. To have considered, ahead of time, what matters to you. To have written down a few sentences that the people around you can read in the first minute. To have given the partner a job.

What you want will not always be what happens. The version of you who is in active labor will know things the version of you who wrote this did not. Trust that version.

The plan is a starting point. The day is yours.

With care, Maya



From Soothemade Notes, a small apothecary of printables, planners, and cards for the unphotographed parts of new parenthood. Made slowly, in plain language.



Soothemade *Notes*

*Made for the version of you no one tells you about, the
one at four in the morning, the one in the parking lot, the
one who doesn't recognize her own week.*

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